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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR /IMPROVEMENT/ REAPPEARANCE

EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025

FIRST SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG1DSCVCN100 - ART OF STORYTELLING

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1.5 Hours **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answer Questions

Answer any **5** of the following

Each Question carries **2** marks

1. What historical element appears in Greek epics? [U] / [CO3]
   - Reference to significant wars such as the Trojan War.
   - Presence of heroic figures based on real tribal leaders.
   - Reflection of early Greek social hierarchy and values.
2. Describe the concept of fate as a theme in ancient epics. [U] / [CO4]
   - Fate is portrayed as a predetermined path controlling human life.
   - Heroes struggle between destiny and personal choice.
   - Represents divine influence, especially from gods like Zeus and Apollo.
   - Shows inevitability despite heroic attempts.
3. Describe how early paintings inspire the evolution of alphabets and languages. [K] / [CO2]
   - Cave paintings used symbolic visuals to express meaning.
   - Pictorial signs gradually developed into pictograms.
   - Example: Egyptian hieroglyphs evolving from symbolic drawings.
   - These early symbols later transformed into phonetic writing systems.
   - Helped structure communication into recognizable linguistic patterns
4. Explain the role of oral tradition in sagas. [K] / [CO3]
   - Preserved cultural memory before written systems emerged.
   - Allowed flexible retelling, making sagas dynamic and evolving.
   - Created strong communal bonding through storytelling sessions.
5. Define the basic structure of a story. [U] / [CO1]
   - Beginning introduces characters, setting, and context.
   - Middle presents conflict or rising action.
   - End resolves the conflict.
   - Example: Most folk tales follow the three-act structure.
6. Discuss the role of audience interpretation in moral storytelling. [An] / [CO5]
   - Audience constructs meaning based on cultural background.

- Moral lessons are interpreted differently by different age groups.
- Encourages personal reflection and ethical understanding.
- Strengthens the educational value of stories.

7. What does Indian epic - Ramayana reveal about the society it emerged from? [K] / [CO3]
   - Emphasis on the concept of dharma (duty).
   - Highlights patriarchal social structure.
   - Promotes ideals of loyalty, devotion, and righteousness.
   - Shows importance of family and community order.

[5x2 = 10]

Part B

Answer any **4** in one Paragraph each
Each Question carries **5** marks

8. Analyze how theme enhances the depth of a story. [An] / [CO5]
   - Theme provides a central message tying the narrative together.
   - Strengthens emotional connection with the reader.
   - Guides character development and motivations.
   - Adds philosophical or moral depth.
   - Helps unify different narrative events.

9. Evaluate the moral conflicts that drive epics characters. [An] / [CO3]
   - Characters often face dilemmas between duty and desire.
   - Conflicts reveal internal struggles and emotional complexity.
   - Example: Arjuna's moral conflict in the Mahabharata.
   - Such conflicts push the narrative forward.
   - Mirror the value systems of the society.
   - Add layers of meaning to the epic tradition.

10. Discuss the use of colour and form in neolithic art. [U] / [CO2]
    - Natural pigments like ochre and charcoal were commonly used.
    - Forms were simple yet symbolic.
    - Visuals represented daily life and rituals.
    - Strengthened group identity and belief systems.
    - Reflected early aesthetic understanding.
    - Conveyed messages without verbal language.

11. Explain the link between religion and creativity in adaptation of epics in literature & performing arts. [An] / [CO4]
    - Religious epics serve as core material for creative reinterpretation.
    - Adaptations reflect spiritual values of different eras.
    - Performing arts use epics to communicate moral teachings.
    - Religious festivals encourage creative retellings.
    - Modern adaptations blend cultural memory with artistic innovation.

12. Explain how early humans developed storytelling through songs. [U] / [CO1]
    - Rhythmic patterns helped in memorizing stories.
    - Songs were used in rituals and community gatherings.
    - Music added emotional depth to narratives.
    - Example: Tribal chants that narrate hunting experiences.
    - Songs acted as a collective memory-preservation tool.
    - Helped develop narrative sequencing.

13. Explain how Indian epic - Mahabharata influenced later literature. [U] / [CO3]
    - Inspired a wide range of poetic and dramatic works.

- Introduced multi-layered narrative structures.
- Provided complex character archetypes.
- Influenced moral and philosophical writing.
- Became the foundation for regional storytelling traditions.

[4x5 = 20]

Part C

Essay Questions

Answer any **2** of the following

Each Question carries **10** marks

14. Discuss how Mesolithic art influenced early civilizations. [A] / [CO2]
    - Depicted hunting techniques and survival practices.
    - Provided visual documentation of community life.
    - Influenced early symbolic communication.
    - Encouraged development of ritualistic traditions.
    - Shaped cultural identity within groups.
    - Example: Mesolithic rock art in India influencing early tribal rituals.
    - Laid groundwork for structured art forms in later civilizations.
    - Demonstrated humans' evolving aesthetic sensibilities.

15. Analyze how Roman epic bridges the oral and literary traditions of its civilization. [An] / [CO3]
    - Borrowed narrative structures from earlier oral storytelling.
    - Written form added permanence and sophistication.
    - Blended mythological stories with historical events.
    - Helped preserve cultural and political ideals.
    - Reflected Roman values such as honour and duty.
    - Example: Virgil’s Aeneid merging myth with state propaganda.
    - Created a national literary identity.

16. Analyze how the basic structure of story applies to both written and visual narratives. [U] / [CO1]
    - Both formats follow beginning, middle, and end structure.
    - Conflict and resolution drive both forms.
    - Visual narratives rely on imagery instead of descriptive text.
    - Themes remain constant across formats.
    - Written narratives allow detailed explanation.
    - Visual narratives provide immediate emotional impact.
    - Both forms engage audiences through storytelling principles.

17. Evaluate how adaptation of epics in theatre, film, television, videogames…etc. mirrors the changing role of stories in human life. [An] / [CO4]
    - Modern media reinterpret epics for contemporary audiences.
    - Technology enhances visual storytelling.
    - Adaptations reflect changing value systems.
    - Example: Film versions of Ramayana highlighting modern perspectives.
    - Increase accessibility of epic narratives.
    - Show evolution of human imagination.
    - Reveal how stories remain relevant across generations.
    - Demonstrate blending of tradition with innovation.
    - Expand storytelling into interactive formats.

[2x10 = 20]